global financial crisis. At that time, the developed countries needed resources for the IMF and looked to the BRICS and other large emerging economies for help. The IMF had underestimated its need for significant financial resources in 2008, only to discover that a $250 billion lending capacity is insufficient in a time of $700 billion bailouts and cross-border capital flows in trillions of dollars. The needed usable resources from IMF quotas and permanent borrowing arrangements had more than tripled, reaching about $750 billion as of early 2011.[39]

As the BRICs were attempting to reform the system, they appreciated the need to increase resources, but at the same time, they had their own priorities, concerns, and grievances. Since about 2002, China had already shown concerns about the stability of the international monetary system and expressed its preference for multipolarity and diversification of reserves to gain greater autonomy and protection from the dominance of the U.S. dollar.[40] At the same time, Chinese leaders and Central Bankers recognized that along with tighter regulation of the United States and other systemically important economies, the world economy was in crisis and needed liquidity. Demonstrating that it was a responsible stakeholder with an interest in defending the existing system, not just reforming it, China agreed to contribute $50 billion to bolster the IMF. However, Beijing coordinated with the other BRICS to leverage their contributions in a public attempt to make a down payment on more rapid reforms and to set the terms on how their contributions would be structured.[41]

As creditors, the BRICS were not prepared to give the IMF open-ended funding. They wanted the IMF to issue its first SDR-denominated bond with short-term maturities to signal their preference that the fund needed to make adjustments to the international monetary regime and stop overrelying on a single national currency as the world's sole reserve.[42] At the same time, the four BRICs planned to shift some foreign reserves into IMF bonds, showing that they have a large voice in global markets. This move led some prominent economists to predict that over time, the status of the U.S. dollar as the world's sole reserve currency might deteriorate.[43] In fact, some BRICs countries had already been agitating to revise the SDR basket of currencies to include their own currencies.

Thus, ahead of the inaugural BRICs summit in Russia, a Chinese official made clear that the group was "asking to increase the voice and representation of emerging economies." China's State Administration of